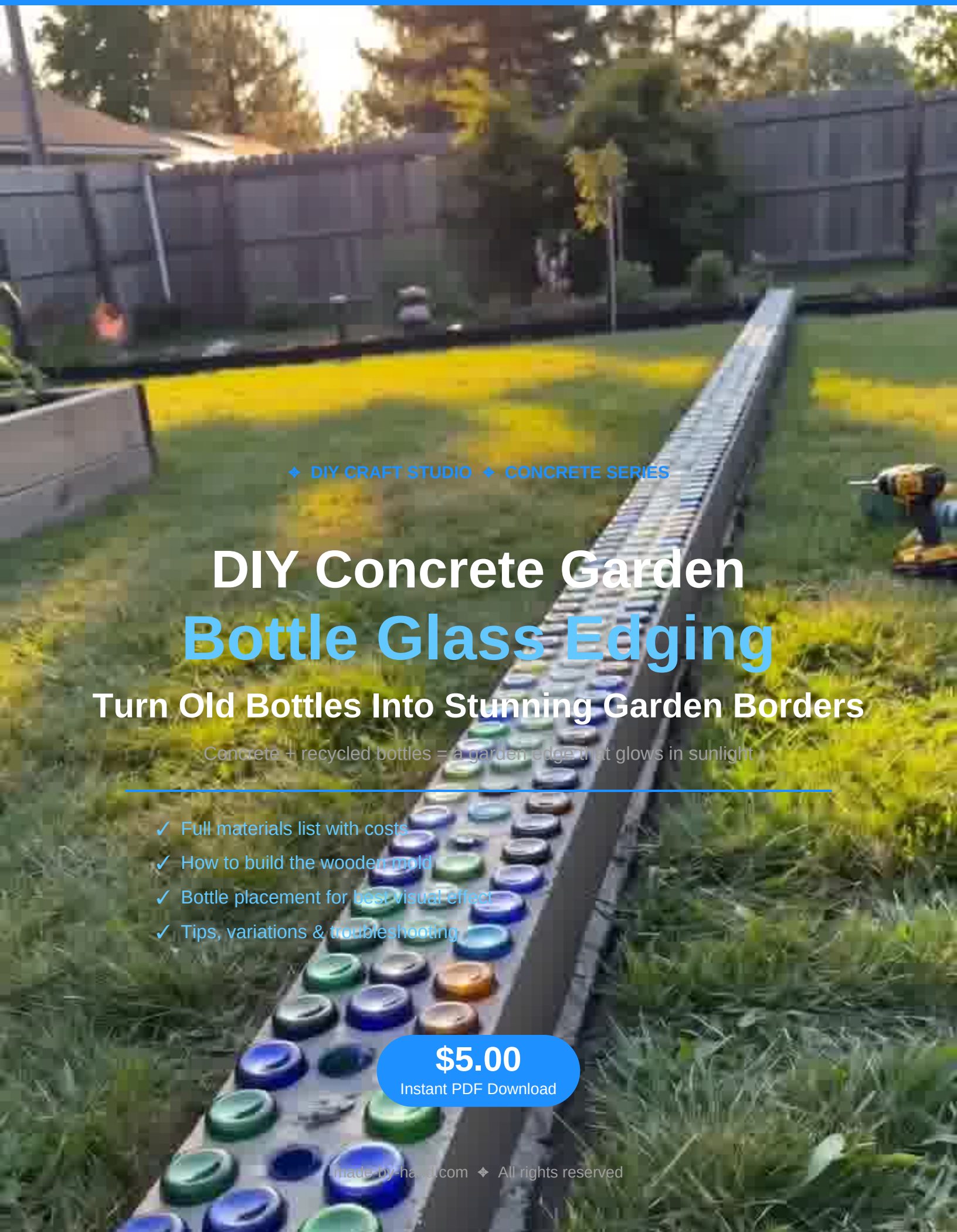

✦ DIY CRAFT STUDIO ✦ CONCRETE SERIES

DIY Concrete Garden Bottle Glass Edging

Turn Old Bottles Into Stunning Garden Borders

Concrete + recycled bottles = a garden edge that glows in sunlight

- ✓ Full materials list with costs
- ✓ How to build the wooden mold
- ✓ Bottle placement for best visual effect
- ✓ Tips, variations & troubleshooting

$5.00
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Materials & What You'll Need

About This Project

This project turns recycled wine, beer, and soda bottles into a spectacular garden border. The glass bottoms are set face-down into fresh concrete inside a wooden mold. Once cured and unmolded, each circle of glass glows in sunlight like stained glass. Total cost: $25–$60. Difficulty: Beginner. You'll need 80–150 bottles per 8-ft section.

■ MATERIALS LIST

ITEM	QUANTITY	COST (EST.)
Quikrete Fast-Setting Concrete (80lb bags)	3–5 bags per 8 ft	**$7–10 each**
Recycled glass bottles (wine, beer, soda)	80–150 per section	**Free / thrift**
2×6 lumber (mold sides)	2× 8 ft lengths	**$8–12**
2×4 lumber (mold ends)	2× short pieces	**$3–5**
Screws or nails (mold assembly)	1 small box	**$4–6**
Cooking spray or vegetable oil (mold release)	1 can	**$3–5**
Rubber mallet	1	**$8–12**
5-gallon bucket + mixing stick	For concrete mixing	**Own/borrow**
Black gloves + safety glasses	Protection	**$5–8**
Garden hose (curing water)	Standard	**Own**
ESTIMATED TOTAL		**$25 – $60 (+ free bottles!)**

■ PRO TIP:

Ask local restaurants, bars, and neighbors to save bottles for you — most will say yes! Mix colors intentionally: blue Bombay Sapphire + green wine bottles + brown beer bottles creates a stunning stained-glass rainbow effect when sunlight hits the concrete.

Step-by-Step Instructions

01 Build the Wooden Mold

Cut 2×6 lumber to your desired length (8 ft is ideal for first timers). Screw the end caps on. The mold should be 5–6 inches wide and 4 inches deep. Spray all inner surfaces with cooking spray or coat with vegetable oil — this is critical!

02 Arrange Bottles Face-Down

Place bottles neck-down (bottom facing up) in the mold in a tight, decorative pattern. Mix colors: blue, green, brown. Push them down so bottoms are flush — they'll become the visible surface. Pack as many as possible for maximum glass effect.

03 Mix & Pour Concrete

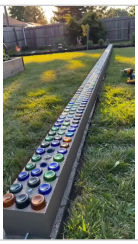
Mix concrete to a thick but pourable consistency (like thick oatmeal). Pour slowly over the bottles, working it around the necks. Tap the mold sides with a rubber mallet to release air bubbles. Fill to the top — level with a screed board.

04 Cure for 48 Hours

Cover with plastic sheeting or damp burlap. Keep in shade — direct sun dries too fast and causes cracking. Lightly mist with water after 24 hours. Do NOT move or flex the mold during this period. Patience = stronger edging.

05 Unmold & Install

Remove screws from the mold ends. Gently flex the sides and lift away. Flip the edging right-side up — the glass bottoms now face up, glowing in the sun! Dig a shallow trench in your garden and set the edging in. Backfill and enjoy! ■



Tips, Variations & Troubleshooting

✦ PRO TIPS FOR BEST RESULTS

- **Uniform depth:** Push every bottle to the same depth so the finished surface is level and even.
- **Plan your colors:** Lay bottles out on the grass first to plan the pattern before the concrete goes in.
- **Tap often:** Use a rubber mallet on the mold sides every few minutes while pouring to prevent voids.
- **Don't over-water:** Concrete that's too wet is weak. Aim for thick oatmeal — it holds shape when you poke it.
- **Cure in shade:** UV and heat cause surface cracking. Keep covered and misted for the full 48 hours.

✦ CREATIVE VARIATIONS

- Make curved sections by building a flexible mold from thin plywood or hardboard
- Use only one color for a monochrome look — all cobalt blue is absolutely stunning
- Add LED strip lights under the edging at night for a glowing garden border effect
- Fill gaps between edging sections with gravel or small river pebbles
- Make shorter pieces (2 ft) for raised beds, planters, or stepping stone borders
- Seal the top surface with outdoor concrete sealer for extra weather resistance

✦ TROUBLESHOOTING

Q: Bottles floating up when I pour
A: Pour concrete in two thin layers. Let the first layer partially set (30 min) before adding more.

Q: Cracks in the finished edging
A: Too much water in the mix, or it dried too fast. Keep moist and shaded for the full cure time.

Q: Mold won't release cleanly
A: More oil next time. Use a putty knife to gently pry the sides — never force it before 48 hours.

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